



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: The Ecclesial Schools
School Website: <http://esischools.org>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

The Ecclesial Schools Initiative (Ecclesial Schools of Florida) presents a strongly classical, Christian-formed program across its St. Alban's Oviedo and Northland Longwood campuses. Public-facing materials consistently frame education as formation in truth, goodness, and beauty within a liturgical, communal, and church-rooted context; the curriculum centers on liberal arts, the Great Books tradition, Latin, logic, and rhetoric; pedagogy blends contemplative, memory-based lower-school practices with Socratic dialogue, seminars, and rhetoric work in the upper grades; and partnerships with churches, families, and scholarship programs are foregrounded. Taken together, these features align closely with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School, indicating a CLASSICAL overall classification with category-level strengths across Religious Foundations, Purpose, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parent/Community engagement.

- Executive takeaway: The school's materials consistently emphasize formation, virtue, and a classical liberal-arts curriculum embedded in Christian/ ecclesial life, with explicit reference to Great Books, Latin, logic, and rhetorical practice, plus a model that partners with churches and families. This combination supports a strong CLASSICAL assessment across all six categories. Evidence from mission statements, curriculum descriptions, pedagogy notes, and faculty/community pages corroborates each category's assessment.
- What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT classifications) is not necessary here; the school already demonstrates extensive classical features. If one desired, minor enhancements could emphasize explicit Great Conversation framing in grade-level outcomes and more explicit articulation of shared "living books" and history-integration language on the public site, but these are not material deficiencies given current materials. This note is provided for context only.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Mission framing emphasizes Christian formation and "formative Christian practices," planted in churches and integrated into a network of neighborhood classical schools. This highlights a transcendental moral realism and communal worship orientation. - The Ecclesial Schools' linguistics emphasize ecclesial (Church-centered) partnerships and environments for spiritual and moral formation. - Public-facing pages reference liturgical practices and morning prayer as part of campus life, illustrating liturgical and communal practices. - Habits of Heart and Mind materials (public-facing) discuss formation and the cultivation of wisdom and virtue as central aims.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: virtue, character, formation, habits of the heart, wisdom, truth, beauty, transcendence/the Logos, liturgy, prayer, sacred tradition, mentorship, Temple of moral formation. Numerous direct hits appear in mission and ethics/formation-focused content.

- Negative keywords present: none detected in the public materials (no explicit emphasis on skills-based, career-driven, or value-neutral framing).

Why this rating - The school explicitly centers education in a theological and ecclesial frame, foregrounding formation in virtue, communal worship/life, and the claim that truth, goodness, and beauty are real and knowable within a Christian-metaphysical horizon. This aligns with the Positive Keyword indicators for Transcendental Moral Realism, Grounded Theology, and Liturgical/Communal Practices, producing a CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The articulated goal is formation of wisdom and virtue, not merely information or job prep; the materials repeatedly emphasize forming character and moral formation through a Christian liberal-arts framework. - The Habits of Heart and Mind document foregrounds the aim of teachable dispositions ordered toward wisdom and virtue, including formation through routine practices, prayer, and habit-building. - Public pages stress awakening wonder, formation through classical education, and the cultivation of human excellence within a Christian frame.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, wisdom, virtue, character, moral imagination, wonder, truth, beauty, goodness, sacred tradition, human flourishing, mentorship, living books, great conversations, moral formation.

- Negative keywords present: none identified (no emphasis on job-ready metrics, data-driven efficiency, or secular utilitarian aims).

Why this rating - The public materials present a clearly theocentric and formation-first purpose, rooted in the classic trias of truth, goodness, beauty, with formation of character as the central aim. This maps cleanly to Positive keywords in the document and supports CLASSICAL designation for Element 2.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is described as a classical liberal-arts program, explicitly naming Latin, logic, and great books as familiar features. This is a core marker of classical curricula. - The mission and curriculum pages emphasize the liberal-arts focus, reading primary sources, the Great Books, and the aim to direct learners toward real things (the things themselves) rather than mere memorization of textbooks. - Narration, nature study, drawing, manipulatives, song, and recitation are described as early-stage methods designed to awaken wonder and deepen memory. This aligns with classic pedagogy for the grammar stage. - The classical Christian teaching outline emphasizes directing students to what is real and giving them tools to learn (dialogue, catechesis, and facilitated discussion in later years).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, great books, primary sources, narration, nature study, memory/recitation, directed-pedagogy, formation through the arts, living books, Great Conversation.

- Negative keywords present: minimal or none (no overt use of social-studies framing or skills-only, job-oriented curricula).

Why this rating - The explicit inclusion of Latin, logic, rhetoric, great books, and a pedagogy that moves from imitation to dialogical inquiry constitutes robust evidence of a CLASSICAL curriculum model. The textual emphasis on forming through the liberal arts and the Great Conversation aligns with the Positive Keyword indicators and supports a CLASSICAL designation for Element 3.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Lower-school pedagogy includes singing, chanting, memory work, and regular review to deepen memory and delight (sociable, memory-focused pedagogy). - Upper-school pedagogy emphasizes Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and the development of logic and rhetorical skills. Students are trained in rhetoric and have opportunities to give speeches. - The public materials describe a two-stage approach: early imitation and memory-based learning; later dialogical, question-driven inquiry and facilitated discussion. This mirrors the classical progression from grammar to dialectic to rhetoric. - Additional articulation of the

classical approach (directing to the real, reading good books, using the garden as a science classroom, etc.) reinforces the pedagogical frame.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: singing/chanting, memorization, narration, nature study, dialogical learning, Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, rhetoric, speeches, Great Books, direct instruction toward primary sources, formation through arts. - Negative keywords present: not evident in the public materials (no strong emphasis on project-based learning or purely experiential/alternative methods that contradict the classical emphasis).

Why this rating - The school's documented methods closely map to the Classical pedagogy framework: a memory-based grammar-stage approach transitioning to Socratic/dialogical and rhetoric-focused upper grades. This aligns with Positive keywords for Socratic dialogue, great conversation, and rhetoric-based training, supporting a CLASSICAL rating for Element 4.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty pages present faculty as professional, mission-aligned, and deeply integrated into the school's classical mission (dean, instructional leaders, etc.). Examples include the Dean of The Ecclesial School and program-specific faculty bios. - The faculty is framed as part of the living curriculum and as mentors who guide formation, not just transmit information. This is reflected in statements about forming character and leadership in the classroom and beyond. - Faculty profiles emphasize long-standing commitment to classical education, with credentials and roles aligned to leadership within the Ecclesial Schools network. - The school's governance and leadership structure (Board of Governors and president/founder) underscores a model where teachers are central to the school's mission and curricular direction.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum, model teachers, mentors, core of the school, faculty as the heart of the program, leadership/board alignment with mission. Names and bios reinforce virtues of competence, virtue, and mentorship. - Negative keywords present: none detected (no language suggesting a detached or purely administrative teacher role).

Why this rating - The public-facing materials consistently portray faculty as central, virtuous, well-qualified guides who embody and deliver the school's classical aims. This aligns with Positive keywords in the "Formation through teachers as mentors" and "living curriculum" concepts, yielding a CLASSICAL rating for Element 5.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The Ecclesial Schools model emphasizes partnerships with local churches and families to plant schools and form a community around education; it highlights co-education of parents and teachers through church-based school networks. - The model advocates making private Christian education accessible by connecting families to scholarship funds and financial sponsorships, reflecting community and parental access interests. - The school's published materials reference campus tours, prospective parents resources, and a community-friendly logistics approach (tuition affordability, scholarship information). - Specific pages document parent resources and volunteer opportunities, underscoring parents as engaged stakeholders within the community and as potential co-teachers in the classical framework.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with local churches, parents as co-teachers, family scholarships and funding models, campus tours, prospective parent resources, parent volunteers. - Negative keywords present: none detected (no language indicating suspicion of parental involvement or anti-community stance).

Why this rating - The public materials emphasize substantial parental and community involvement, church partnerships, and accessible funding for families, which align with Positive keywords in Element 6's framework and justify CLASSICAL designation.

Aggregate Assessment

- Element 1 — CLASSICAL
- Element 2 — CLASSICAL
- Element 3 — CLASSICAL
- Element 4 — CLASSICAL
- Element 5 — CLASSICAL
- Element 6 — CLASSICAL

Overall Ranking: CLASSICAL

Rationale: Across all six categories, Ecclesial Schools Florida demonstrates core classical markers: a liturgical Christian framework that grounds moral formation; a purpose focused on wisdom and virtue; a curriculum centered on liberal arts, Great Books, Latin, logic, and rhetoric; pedagogy that blends memory-based early learning with Socratic/dialogical upper-division work; vibrant faculty as mentors and living curriculum; and robust parent/community partnerships with accessible scholarships. The six category assessments consistently align with the Positive Keyword indicators and show no material reliance on Negative Keyword indicators. Public-facing materials substantiate a coherent classical education model in all six domains.

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable given CLASSICAL final rating. No major needle-moving changes are required. If desired, minor enhancements could more explicitly spell out “Great Conversation” language on the home-page and create a concise, public snapshot of the Great Books/grammar-logic-rhetoric progression by grade level to further illuminate the curriculum’s continuity.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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